

VITAL TARGET

An Additional Scoring Method for *Warhammer: The Horus Heresy* (Third Edition)

Unofficial / fan-made content. Compatible with any Age of Darkness battle by mutual agreement. Working title alternatives: Prized Materiel · The Reliquary · Vital Cache · Spoils of War · War Trophy.

The Concept

Vital Target is a scoring method built around a single hobby centrepiece. Before the battle, each player designs and models one thematic objective for their army — their **Target** — mounted on a 100mm base. During the game, holding onto your own Target is worth points. But the enemy has every reason to hunt it down: a defiled Target is worth **twice as much to them** as an intact one is to you.

Building a Target

Each player must supply one **Target** before the battle, built to the following requirements.

- **Base.** The Target must be modelled upon a single **100mm round base** (a 100mm square is acceptable by mutual agreement). It is treated as one coherent piece of scenery.
- **Theme.** The Target must clearly represent something meaningful to the modelling player's army — its Legion, its allegiance, its warlord, or its way of war. It should look like it *belongs* to that force.
- **Presentation.** Players are encouraged to treat the Target as a centrepiece and to paint and detail it accordingly.

Designer's Note: There is no wrong answer. The Target can be grim, triumphant, gruesome, or absurd — a shrine, an ammunition dump, a heap of trophies, a half-summoned horror. If it makes an opponent lean across the table for a closer look, it has done its job. See the *Thematic Inspiration* appendix for prompts.

Target Profile

A Target is a piece of **impassable area terrain** with the following characteristics. It is never a unit and never a model in the ordinary sense.

Toughness	Wounds	Save
8	5	4+

A Target has no Weapon Skill, Ballistic Skill, Strength, Initiative, Attacks, or Mental Stats. It cannot move, act, embark, disembark, or make attacks of any kind.

Special Rules — a Target always has all of the following:

- **Impassable Centrepiece.** A Target is impassable area terrain. Models may not move onto or through it, and may not be placed atop it. It blocks line of sight as its physical model dictates and grants a 5+ **Cover Save** to units legitimately obscured by it. Models may move into base contact around its edge.
 - **Inanimate.** A Target automatically passes or is unaffected by any test or effect that targets a unit or a model's mind or morale — including Pinning, Morale, Fear, Sweeping Advance, Instant Death, and any rule that removes models "from play" without inflicting Wounds. It has no characteristic that can be reduced. It can only be brought down by losing Wounds.
 - **Not a Combatant.** A Target cannot be locked in combat and cannot be joined by characters. A unit attacking a Target in the Assault phase is **not** considered locked in combat.
 - **Warded Bulk.** A Target does not benefit from Cover Saves itself (it is the target) and has no Invulnerable Save unless specified by an Optional Rule below.
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Deploying a Target

Targets are placed at the **start of deployment**, after deployment zones and all other terrain have been established and before any units are deployed. Each player places their own Target simultaneously.

A Target must be placed:

- Wholly within its owner's deployment zone,
- With its base more than **6"** from any battlefield edge,
- More than **3"** from any other model, terrain feature, or objective marker,
- On a surface flat enough to seat a 100mm base securely.

Once placed, a Target does not move for the remainder of the battle by any means.

Destroying a Target

A Target can be attacked and destroyed by any force on the battlefield.

- **Shooting.** Enemy (or friendly — see below) units may target a Target in the Shooting phase, rolling To Hit as normal against a stationary target of its size. Blast markers and templates that cover the Target strike it automatically, as normal.
- **Assault.** A unit in base contact with a Target may attack it in the Assault phase. Because a Target cannot evade, **all melee attacks against it hit automatically**. Resolve Wounds against Toughness 8 with a 4+ Save.

- **Any source counts.** A Target can be damaged by *any* attack, friend or foe. A scattering blast from your own line is as ruinous as an enemy melta-gun.

When a Target is reduced to **0 Wounds it is Destroyed**. Its owner's opponent immediately and permanently claims the reward described below. The physical model may be left in place as ruined, impassable terrain (recommended, for narrative flavour) or removed by mutual agreement; either way it no longer scores and cannot be restored except by an Optional Rule.

Victory Points

If both players agree to use this method, the following Victory Points are scored **in addition** to those of the chosen mission. Each player's Target is resolved independently.

- **Intact at battle's end — 3 VP to its owner.** If your Target has not been Destroyed by the end of the final turn, you score **3 Victory Points**.
- **Destroyed at any point — 6 VP to its opponent.** The instant your Target is Destroyed, your opponent scores **6 Victory Points**. This award is permanent and is kept even if the battle continues, and even if the Target was felled by its owner's own fire. A Destroyed Target scores nothing for its owner.

Designer's Note — Why 3 and 6? Keeping your own supplies safe is expected of any competent commander; it is worth a modest reward. Reducing the enemy's most cherished possession to slag is a different thing entirely — a blow to morale and a trophy for the propagandists. This asymmetry is deliberate as it pressures both players to *commit* to the hunt rather than merely turtle.

Additional Rules & Clarifications

- **Permanence.** Destruction is final. A Target once Destroyed cannot regain Wounds or re-earn the 3 VP unless an Optional Rule says otherwise.
 - **Both Targets destroyed.** Each player scores 6 VP for the enemy Target they felled. Structurally the method is symmetrical; the swing simply favours whoever strikes cleanest and defends best.
 - **Terrain interactions.** A Target counts as terrain for all rules *except* this scoring method. It does not hold, contest, or deny mission objectives, does not count toward table quarters, and is never a scoring or denial unit.
 - **Line of sight.** A Target blocks and grants line of sight and cover exactly as its physical model does. This is a real tactical consideration in placement — a Target can anchor a firebase or screen an advance, at the risk of drawing fire.
 - **Sportsmanship.** As with any modelled terrain, agree that both Targets are acceptable — in theme, size, and fairness — before the first dice are rolled.
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Optional Rules

Use any of the following by mutual agreement.

- **Escalating Stakes.** For larger games, increase a Target's Wounds by **+1 for every full 1,000 points** in each army above 3,000. This keeps a Target meaningfully durable as firepower scales.
- **Field Reconsecration.** A friendly, non-vehicle unit that begins and ends its Movement phase in base contact with its own Target and does nothing else that turn may restore **1 Wound** to it on a successful intelligence check (never above its starting total). A Destroyed Target cannot be restored.
- **The Defiler's Bounty.** The unit that lands the killing blow on an enemy Target gains the *Fear* special rule (or **+1 Ld** if it already causes Fear) for the rest of the battle, emboldened by the desecration.
- **Best in Show.** Purely for the hobby: before the battle, an impartial judge or the two players together may award **1 bonus VP** to whichever Target is the better-presented. Recommended for narrative and open play; drop it for tightly competitive events.

Appendix: Thematic Inspiration

Prompts only — the more personal, the better.

Faction	A Target might be...
Word Bearers	A daemonic summoning circle, mid-ritual, brazier and chained scripture.
Iron Warriors	Stacked siege shells and demolition charges, precise as a blueprint.
World Eaters	Crates of spare chainaxe teeth; a gore-slick butcher's altar.
Death Guard	Barrels of alchemical toxins around a wax-sealed plague reliquary.
Emperor's Children	A sonic amplifier array draped in gilded, looted trophies.
Sons of Horus	The Warmaster's spare banners and a cache of captured Imperial standards.
Thousand Sons	An arcane orrery, or a tome-shrine of forbidden lore.
Ultramarines	A Codex archive and honour-banners over crated, labelled supplies.
Dark Angels	A plasma-tech armoury, or a relic hauled from Caliban.
Blood Angels	A red-grail reliquary and medicae blood stores.
Space Wolves	A trophy-pile from the mead hall; preserved

Faction	A Target might be...
	kills on iron hooks.
Imperial Fists	A fortified munitions emplacement, sandbagged and ranging-marked.
Salamanders	A portable field-forge and a rack of master-crafted wargear.
Raven Guard	A covert dead-drop — a nondescript cache, easily missed.
White Scars	Fuel drums and ammunition for the bikes, trophy poles staked around.
Iron Hands	A cortex-array shrine amid bionics and salvaged parts.
Night Lords	A gallows of flayed banners and terror-trophies.
Alpha Legion	An unmarked crate. It could be anything. That is the point.
Mechanicum	A cogitator-shrine guarding a fragment of holy STC.
Solar Auxilia / Army	An ammo dump and fuel bowsers under a regimental standard.

Model it well. Guard it better. And when the enemy's Target lies broken, be sure the propagandists are watching.